



Discussion Guide: Julian Davis Reid

The Chord Changes

Reflect

- Julian introduces the idea of “chord changes” as a way of thinking about shifts and movements in our own lives of faith. What about this metaphor was helpful to you? What questions do you have about it?
- Describe a time when you, like Julian in his opening story, missed the chord changes that were happening around you. What were the circumstances and what was this experience like?
- What makes it difficult to hear God’s bass notes (i.e., deep truths and values) in our world today?

Respond

- Julian suggests that the “melody” of our lives speaks to the true thing that we are to speak or live into. What melodies are you paying attention to in this season of life?
- In Julian’s metaphor, the harmony accompanies the melody and “speaks life” into it. Who are the harmonic voices in your life and how are they supporting you?
- When it comes to your hope for change in the world, is your struggle more about lagging behind the beat (nostalgia) or getting too far ahead of it?